

# DIVINE DECEPTION

A SOUTHERN GOTHIC THRILLER

SET IN THE SHADOWS OF FAITH

A SOUTHERN GOSPEL NOIR

# DIVINE DECEPTION

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# STORY & HOOK

## Why Now?

- Inspired by real-world revelations about **institutional abuse** in faith communities.
- Centers a courageous **Black female lead** speaking truth to power.
- Tackles silence, complicity, and survival in a culturally specific Southern world.



*A gospel star returns home to bury her grandmother—and unearths the secrets of a pastor who may be her father, and her mother's rapist.*

# SYNOPSIS

## Three-Act Breakdown:

### Act I:

Funeral triggers questions. Hidden ledger. Family secrets.

### Act II:

Town divides. Evidence mounts. Harmony goes public.

### Act III:

Courtroom showdown. Pastor falls. The town begins to heal.

*"A powerful story of truth, justice, and redemption set against the backdrop of a Southern community bound by faith and secrets."*



*The hidden ledger that reveals decades of financial manipulation and hush money payments*

# MAIN CHARACTERS



## Harmony Wells

Gospel star turned truth-teller. Fierce. Haunted.

## Faith Cross

Pastor's daughter. Loyal, then torn.

## Blessed Wells

A mother who chose silence to survive.

## Marcus Wells

Regretful father, seeking redemption.

## Pastor Jonathan Cross

Charismatic predator.

## Supporting Cast

Sister Margaret, Agent Vance, Treasurer Wong

# tone & visual style



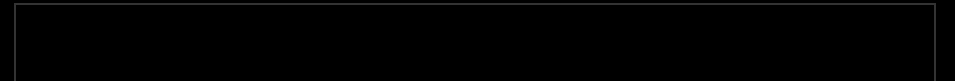
## Aesthetic: Southern Gothic x Modern Noir

- Rich shadows, candlelight, and stained glass reflections.
- Voiceover narration. Grit meets poetry.
- Haunting gospel music underscores key moments.
- Contrasting worlds: church opulence vs. modest homes.

## Color Palette:



Deep Burgundy (#800020)



Jet Black (#000000)



Muted Gold (#D4AF37)



Ashen White (#F5F5F5)



# THE WORLD



*A fictional town outside Atlanta, GA*



*Shadows and light play across sacred spaces*

## The Megachurch as Empire

- Spiritual: Dominates the town's moral compass
- Financial: Controls local businesses and charity
- Political: Influences law enforcement and courts

## Key Locations

|                  |            |
|------------------|------------|
| Fellowship Halls | Graveyards |
| Sanctuaries      | Jailhouses |

*"The town breathes legacy, and bleeds when secrets surface."*

# TARGET AUDIENCE

## Primary

Women 25–54 (Lifetime core demo)

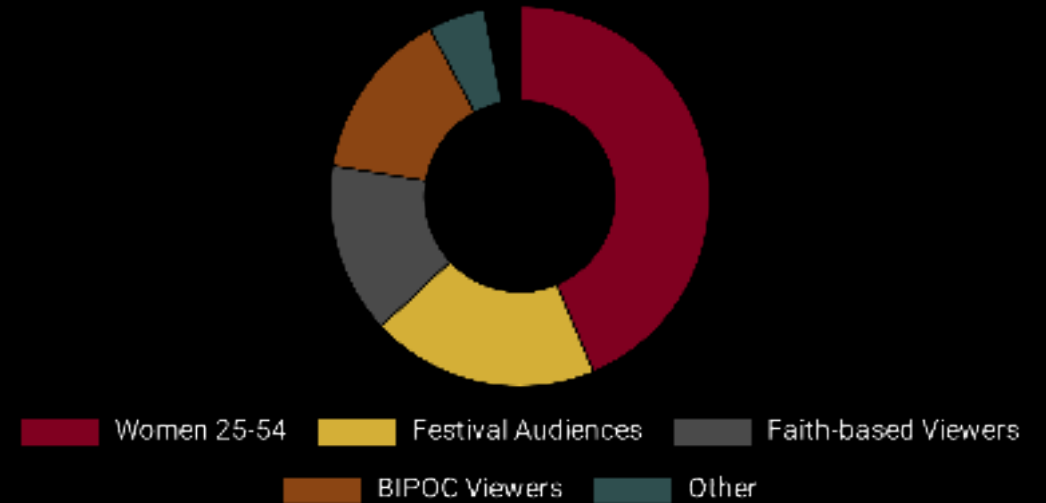
## Secondary

- Festival audiences
- Faith-based reformers
- BIPOC viewers

## Cross-market with:

- Greenleaf
- Eve's Bayou
- Secrets of a Marine's Wife

Target Audience Breakdown



*Projected audience demographics based on comparable titles*

# COMPARABLE PROJECTS

| Title             | Why It's Comparable                                                                                                                                    |
|-------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Greenleaf         | Church corruption, Black female leads, family dynamics within a powerful religious institution. Similar themes of power abuse and generational trauma. |
| Eve's Bayou       | Southern mood, legacy, family secrets. Shares our film's Southern Gothic aesthetic and exploration of how buried truths impact a community.            |
| Doubt             | Abuse allegations vs. institutional power. Examines the moral complexity of confronting authority figures and the cost of speaking truth.              |
| The Clark Sisters | Gospel culture, trauma, sisterhood. Explores the intersection of faith, music, and family bonds in the Black community.                                |

*"Divine Deception Noir combines elements from these successful projects while offering a unique Southern Gothic noir perspective on faith, justice, and redemption."*



# FINAL NOTE

Voiceover (Harmony):

*"Funny thing about truth.*

*It doesn't save you.*

*But it frees you enough to save yourself."*

*The sanctuary in half-light. A girl begins a new song.*

Contact: NCCA Entertainment | Kelly Tenney